Employee Code of Conduct

Verhaltenskodex für Mitarbeitende

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Applies to	All employees, trainees, working students and interns of Norvane Systems GmbH at all sites (Munich, Berlin, Garching, Frankfurt); contractors and temporary agency staff while working on our premises or with our systems
Classification	Internal
Language	English. A German version is available from HR on request.

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1 Purpose and scope

As an employee of Norvane Systems, you are responsible for behaving appropriately at work. This Code of Conduct is one of the most important parts of our Employee Handbook. It sets out our expectations in a clear and respectful manner.

We cannot cover every single case of conduct, but we trust you to always use your best judgement. If you face any issues or have any questions, reach out to your line manager or to HR (hr@norvane.example, ext. 2000). You can also contact the Works Council (Betriebsrat) or our ethics hotline (ethics@norvane.example, ext. 2650); see section 8.

HR acts as the complaints office (Beschwerdestelle) under the General Equal Treatment Act (Allgemeines Gleichbehandlungsgesetz, AGG). Nobody will be disadvantaged for raising a concern in good faith.

2 Dress code

Our official dress code is smart casual. This includes chinos or slacks, shirts or blouses, knitwear, loafers, clean sneakers and boots. However, an employee's position and the setting may also inform how they should dress. If you frequently meet customers or prospects, please conform to a more formal dress code (business casual). We expect you to be clean when coming to work and to avoid clothes that are unprofessional (for example workout clothes or clothing with offensive slogans or images).

The following applies by setting:

Setting	Dress code	Notes
Munich HQ and Berlin office, internal work	Smart casual	Hybrid days at home and video calls: please dress as you would for the office.
Customer meetings, customer sites, audits, interviews	Business casual	For example slacks, blouse or shirt, loafers or boots; a jacket is welcome, a tie is not required.
Garching hardware depot and device-staging warehouse	Practical workwear	Safety shoes and high-visibility clothing where required by the risk assessment (Gefährdungsbeurteilung). Norvane provides personal protective equipment free of charge; instructions from the Safety Officer (Carlos Mendes, ext. 2400) apply.
Frankfurt colocated data center	Smart casual with closed shoes	No loose clothing or jewellery near equipment; site access rules apply.

As long as you conform with these guidelines, we have no specific expectations about which clothes or accessories you wear. We also respect and permit grooming styles, clothing and accessories that are dictated by religious or ideological beliefs, ethnicity or disability.

3 Cyber security and digital devices

This section deals with all things digital at work. It sets guidelines for using computers, phones, our internet connection and social media to ensure security and protect our assets. It supplements the Information Security

Policy (NS-IT-POL-001), which takes precedence in technical matters, and the Data Protection Policy (NS-LEG-POL-001).

3.1 Internet usage

Our corporate internet connection is primarily for business. You may occasionally use it for personal purposes as long as this does not interfere with your job responsibilities. We also expect you to temporarily halt personal activities that slow down our internet connection (for example uploading photos) if IT asks you to.

You must not use our internet connection to:

- download or upload obscene, offensive or illegal material;
- send confidential information to unauthorized recipients;
- invade another person's privacy or gain access to sensitive information;
- download or upload pirated movies, music, material or software;
- visit potentially dangerous websites that can compromise the safety of our network and computers;
- perform unauthorized or illegal actions, such as hacking, fraud or buying or selling illegal goods.

3.2 Mobile phones

We allow the use of mobile phones at work. We also want to ensure that your devices do not distract you from your work or disrupt our workplace. We ask you to follow a few simple rules:

- Use your phone in a manner that benefits your work (business calls, productivity apps, calendars).
- Keep personal calls brief and use an empty meeting room or common area so as not to disturb your colleagues.
- Avoid playing games on your phone or texting excessively.
- Do not use your phone for any reason while driving a company vehicle.
- Do not use your phone to record confidential information.
- Do not download or upload inappropriate, illegal or obscene material using our corporate internet connection.

You must also not use your phone in areas where mobile phone use is explicitly prohibited, for example the server halls of the Frankfurt data center and the secured staging area at the Garching depot.

3.3 Corporate email

Email is essential to our work. You should use your company email address (firstname.lastname@norvane.example) primarily for work, but we allow some uses for personal reasons.

Use	What is allowed	Example
Work-related use	Without limitations.	Signing up for newsletters and online services that help you in your job or professional growth.
Personal use	Allowed as long as you keep your account safe, avoid spamming and do not disclose confidential information.	Emails to friends and family; downloading ebooks, guides and other safe content for personal use.

The extent to which email traffic is logged is limited by data protection law (GDPR/DSGVO, BDSG) and agreed with the Works Council (Betriebsrat). Details are set out in NS-IT-POL-001.

Our general expectations

No matter how you use your corporate email, we expect you to avoid:

- signing up for illegal, unreliable, disreputable or suspect websites and services;
- sending unauthorized marketing content or emails;
- registering for a competitor's services, unless authorized;
- sending insulting or discriminatory messages and content;
- spamming other people's mailboxes, including those of your coworkers.

In general, use strong passwords and be vigilant in spotting emails that carry malware or phishing attempts. If you are not sure that an email you received is safe, do not open attachments or links. Report it with the "Report phishing" button in Outlook or ask our security specialists via the IT helpdesk (helpdesk@norvane.example, ext. 3000).

3.4 Social media

We want to provide practical advice to prevent careless use of social media in our workplace. We address two types of use: using personal social media at work and representing our company through social media.

Using personal social media at work

You may access your personal accounts at work. We expect you to act responsibly, in line with our policies, and to stay productive. Specifically, we ask you to:

- **Discipline yourself.** Avoid getting sidetracked by your social platforms.
- **Make clear that your personal account or statements do not represent our company.** For example, use a disclaimer such as "opinions are my own".
- **Avoid sharing intellectual property (for example trademarks) or confidential information.** Ask your manager or our Marketing & Communications team (comms@norvane.example, ext. 5200) first before you share company news that has not been officially announced.
- **Avoid any defamatory, offensive or derogatory content.** If you direct such content towards colleagues, customers or partners, you may violate our rules on harassment and discrimination (AGG).

Representing our company through social media

If you handle our social media accounts or speak on our company's behalf, we expect you to protect our company's image and reputation. Specifically, you should:

- be respectful, polite and patient;
- avoid speaking on matters outside your field of expertise when possible;
- follow our confidentiality and data protection policies and observe laws governing copyright, trademarks, plagiarism and fair use;
- coordinate with our Marketing & Communications team (comms@norvane.example, ext. 5200) when you are about to share any major-impact content;
- avoid deleting or ignoring comments for no reason;
- correct or remove any misleading or false content as quickly as possible.

4 Conflict of interest

When you are experiencing a conflict of interest, your personal goals are no longer aligned with your responsibilities towards us. For example, owning shares of one of our competitors is a conflict of interest.

In other cases, you may be faced with an ethical issue. For example, accepting a bribe may benefit you financially, but it is illegal and against our business code of ethics. If we become aware of such behaviour, we will take disciplinary action, which can include a formal warning (Abmahnung) or termination of employment, in accordance with German employment law and with involvement of the Works Council (Betriebsrat) as required. You may also face criminal consequences.

For this reason, conflicts of interest are a serious issue for all of us. We expect you to be vigilant in spotting circumstances that create conflicts of interest, either for yourself or for your direct reports. Follow our policies and always act in the best interests of Norvane Systems. Whenever possible, do not let personal or financial interests get in the way of your job. If you are experiencing an ethical dilemma, talk to your manager or HR and we will try to help you resolve it.

Typical situations and what we expect:

Situation	What we expect	Contact
You or a close relative own shares in a competitor	Disclose it to your line manager and HR in writing before the situation continues.	HR, ext. 2000
Secondary employment (Nebentätigkeit) for a competitor, customer or supplier	Obtain written approval from HR before you start.	Jordan Ellis, ext. 2020
Gifts or hospitality from customers or suppliers	Politely decline anything above EUR 50 in value, or report it to your line manager and the ethics hotline. Never accept cash or anything offered in exchange for a decision.	ethics@norvane.example, ext. 2650
A relative or close friend works for a supplier or customer you deal with	Tell your line manager. You must not take part in the selection or the contract decision.	Ingrid Larsen (Procurement), ext. 6000
You are offered a bribe or are asked to pay one	Refuse, do not discuss terms, and report it immediately.	Dr. Nadia Petrov, ext. 2600

5 Employee relationships

We want to ensure that relationships between employees are appropriate and harmonious. This section outlines our guidelines, and we ask you to always behave professionally.

5.1 Fraternization

Fraternization refers to dating or being friends with your colleagues. In this policy, "dating" means consensual romantic relationships and sexual relations. Non-consensual relationships constitute sexual violence and we prohibit them explicitly. Sexual harassment in the workplace is a violation of the AGG and will be handled by HR as the complaints office (Beschwerdestelle).

5.2 Dating colleagues

If you start dating a colleague, we expect you to maintain professionalism and keep personal discussions outside of our workplace.

You are also obliged to respect colleagues who date each other. We will not tolerate sexual jokes, malicious gossip or improper comments. If you witness this kind of behaviour, please report it to HR.

5.3 Dating managers

To avoid accusations of favouritism, abuse of authority and sexual harassment, managers must not be in a romantic relationship with their direct reports. This restriction extends to every manager above an employee in the reporting line. If such a relationship arises, the manager must inform HR in confidence without delay, so that the reporting line can be changed. Information shared in this context is treated as confidential and used only for this purpose.

Also, if you act as a hiring manager, you are not allowed to hire your partner into your team. You can refer them for employment to other teams or departments where you do not have any managerial or hiring authority.

5.4 Friendships at work

Employees who work together may naturally form friendships, either in or outside of the workplace. We encourage these relationships between peers, as they can help you communicate and collaborate. We do expect you to focus on your work and to keep personal disputes outside of our workplace.

5.5 Employment of relatives

Everyone in our company should be hired, recognized or promoted because of their skills, character and work ethic. We do not want to see nepotism, favouritism or conflicts of interest, so we place some restrictions on hiring employees' relatives.

At Norvane Systems, a "relative" is someone who is related by blood or marriage within the third degree to an employee. This includes parents, grandparents, in-laws, spouses or domestic partners, children, grandchildren, siblings, uncles, aunts, nieces, nephews, step-parents, step-children and adopted children.

As an employee, you can refer your relatives to work with our company. Our only restrictions are:

- You must not be involved in a supervisory or reporting relationship with a relative.
- You cannot be transferred, promoted or hired into a reporting relationship with a relative.
- You cannot be part of a hiring committee when your relative is interviewed for that position.

If you become related to a manager or direct report after you both become employed by Norvane Systems, we may have to transfer one of you to a different team. HR will discuss the options with both of you first and will involve the Works Council (Betriebsrat) where required by law.

6 Workplace visitors

If you want to invite a visitor to our offices, please ask your line manager for permission first and register the visit in advance with building security (security@norvane.example, ext. 9111). Please also inform reception (Munich and Berlin) or the gate (Garching and Frankfurt) of your visitor's arrival. Visitors sign in and show identification. They receive a visitor pass and are asked to return it to reception or the gate once their visit is complete.

Site	Visitors register at	Register in advance	Additional rules
Munich HQ, Parkring 12	Reception	By 16:00 on the previous working day	Visitors stay in meeting rooms and common areas unless escorted.
Berlin office	Front office	By 16:00 on the previous working day	As Munich HQ.

Garching depot and staging warehouse	Gate	By 16:00 on the previous working day	Safety instruction and visitor PPE before entering the warehouse; no access to vehicle and forklift areas without an escort.
Frankfurt data center	Gate A	Two working days ahead, with approval by the CISO (Priya Raman)	Photo ID required; visitors are escorted at all times.

When you have visitors, you also have responsibilities. You should:

- always look after your visitors (especially when they are underage);
- keep your visitors away from areas with dangerous machines, vehicles, chemicals, confidential records or sensitive equipment;
- prevent your visitors from proselytizing colleagues, collecting donations or asking for participation in activities on our premises;
- escort your visitors to the assembly point if an alarm sounds (see NS-EHS-PRC-001).

Anyone who delivers orders, mail or packages for employees should remain at the reception of our building or at the gate. If you are expecting a delivery, reception staff (Munich, Berlin) or the gate security staff (Garching, Frankfurt) will notify you so you can collect it.

7 Solicitation and distribution

Solicitation is any form of requesting money, support or participation for products, groups, organizations or causes that are unrelated to our company (for example religious proselytism or asking for petition signatures). Distribution means disseminating literature or material for commercial or political purposes.

We do not allow solicitation and distribution by non-employees in our workplace. As an employee, you may solicit from your colleagues only when you want to:

- ask colleagues to help organize events for another employee (for example the birth or adoption of a child, a promotion or retirement);
- seek support for a cause, charity or fundraising event sponsored, funded, organized or authorized by our company;
- invite colleagues to employee activities for an authorized non-business purpose (for example recreation or volunteering);
- ask colleagues to take part in employment-related activities or groups protected by law (for example trade union activities or the work of the Works Council (Betriebsrat), in line with the Works Constitution Act, BetrVG).

In all cases, we ask that you do not disturb or distract colleagues from their work.

8 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
General questions, complaints (AGG)	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000

Policy owner	Julia Neumann, HR Director	julia.neumann@norvane.example	2001
Employee assistance (EAP)	Mariam Haddad, HR Business Partner	eap@norvane.example	2010
Employee representation	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500
Ethics hotline, conflicts of interest	Dr. Nadia Petrov, General Counsel	ethics@norvane.example	2650
IT and phishing reports	IT helpdesk	helpdesk@norvane.example	3000
Information security	Priya Raman, CISO	priya.raman@norvane.example	3100
Social media, external statements	Marketing & Communications	comms@norvane.example	5200
Visitors, building security (24/7)	Building security	security@norvane.example	9111

9 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-HR-POL-004	Workplace Policies	Further workplace rules in the Employee Handbook
NS-IT-POL-001	Information Security Policy	Internet, email and device rules (section 3)
NS-LEG-POL-001	Data Protection Policy	Monitoring and personal data (section 3)
NS-EHS-PRC-001	Emergency and Evacuation Procedure	Visitors during an alarm (section 6)

10 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	15.03.2023	Julia Neumann	First issue.
2.0	01.02.2024	Julia Neumann	Added social media rules and the section on visitors.
2.1	01.07.2025	Jordan Ellis	Updated contact details; added site-specific visitor rules.
3.0	01.04.2026	Julia Neumann	Full revision after consultation with the Works Council; conflict-of-interest table added; relationship rules aligned with German law.

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